

Computer Security

Tutorial Questions (40 Marks)

Topic: Security Law & Legal Issues

Time Allowed: 30 Minutes
Based on Lecture 13 slides.

Section A: Scenario-Based Questions (20 Marks)

Question 1 (5 Marks)

A software developer created a mobile application for online food delivery. Another company copied the interface design and source code without permission and started selling a similar application.

Required:

- a) Identify the type of intellectual property protection violated in this case. (1 mark)
- b) Explain why copyright protection is important for software developers. (2 marks)
- c) State TWO characteristics required for intellectual property to receive copyright protection. (2 marks)

Question 2 (5 Marks)

An employee developed a cybersecurity monitoring tool at home during weekends. However, the tool is related to the company's business operations.

Later, the employee attempted to sell the software independently.

Required:

- a) Explain ONE ownership issue that may arise in this scenario. (2 marks)
- b) Define "work for hire." (1 mark)
- c) Explain why employment contracts are important in software development organizations. (2 marks)

Question 3 (5 Marks)

A university student discovered a serious vulnerability in an online banking application. Without informing the bank, the student immediately posted the vulnerability details publicly on social media.

Required:

- a) Explain ONE risk of publicly disclosing vulnerabilities immediately. (2 marks)
- b) Define responsible vulnerability reporting. (2 marks)
- c) State ONE role of a vulnerability coordinator such as CERT. (1 mark)

Question 4 (5 Marks)

A company collects customer shopping history through loyalty cards and uses data mining techniques to analyze purchasing behavior.

Some customers later complain that their privacy has been violated.

Required:

- a) Explain why data mining may become a privacy concern. (2 marks)
- b) Identify ONE threat to privacy in this scenario. (1 mark)
- c) Suggest TWO controls that can help protect customer privacy. (2 marks)

Section B: Logic & Analytical Questions (20 Marks)

Question 5 (10 Marks)

A hacker illegally accessed a company database and copied thousands of customer records containing names, addresses, and financial information.

The attacker claimed that “data is not physical property, so stealing it is not a crime.”

Required:

- a) Explain why computer crime laws are necessary in modern computing environments. (4 marks)
- b) Explain TWO difficulties faced in prosecuting computer crimes. (4 marks)
- c) Explain why data is considered valuable property in computer security. (2 marks)

Question 6 (10 Marks)

A social media company tracks user behavior, browsing habits, and location data to improve targeted advertising.

The company argues that users accepted the terms and conditions, so ethical concerns do not exist.

Required:

- a) Differentiate between law and ethics in computer security. (4 marks)
- b) Explain ONE ethical issue related to excessive user data collection. (3 marks)
- c) Discuss whether legal compliance alone is sufficient for ethical behavior in cybersecurity. (3 marks)

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